

LDT4SSC Project Methodology

Step 2: VALIDATE (Specifications)

Data Governance Workshop

**Workshop: Designing your Data
Governance Roadmap: From
Chief Data Officer Mission
Statement to Action**

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Document History

Date	Version	Edited by	Description
May 2026	v1	Marine Le Gall, Laura Riou, Sophie Houzet	First version adapted from the CAPACities program.

Workshop Overview

Title	Designing your Data Governance Roadmap: From Chief Data Officer Mission Statement to Action
Methodological step	Step 2: VALIDATE (Specifications)
Duration	2 hours and 5 mins
Number of Facilitators	1 for each group of 4 to 5 people
Equipment Needed	• One big sheet of paper (1m/2m) or a large (digital) whiteboard • Sticky notes • Pens and markers
Expected outputs	• Mission statement/job profile for the Chief Data Officer. • Data-governance strategy roadmap with timeframes. • List of roadmap actions for organisational (including HR), technical and legal aspects. • A summary note produced after the workshop, outlining key findings and next steps.

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1. Context and objectives

The **Designing your Data Governance Roadmap** workshop is part of the **VALIDATE step (specification)** which bridges the gap between the project's initial idea and its practical implementation. It translates the use cases into **technical and functional requirements**, while accounting for real-world constraints such as interoperability, data, architecture, security, and putting the user's needs at the center.

More information on the objectives, prerequisites and stakeholders to involve in the EXPLORE step can be found on the LDT4SSC Knowledge Hub¹.

The workshop is designed to achieve the following objectives:

- Define the role and **responsibilities of an ideal** (fictive) **Chief Data Officer**.
- Develop a **detailed roadmap** using the Chief Data Officer's mission statement, covering **organisational, technical and human resource** aspects.
- Assign **roles, timelines, and resources** for governance implementation.

2. Workshop

2.1. Workshop phases overview

<i>Time spent</i>	<i>Phase</i>	<i>Description</i>
15 mins	0. Framing and Icebreaker	Participants revisit the selected use case and project objectives to keep discussions grounded.
45 mins	1. Drafting the Mission Statement	Participants work in two subgroups to define the scope and functions of a data governance lead from different perspectives (internal authority vs. external partner).
45 mins	2. Build the roadmap	Participants map actions required to implement the mission statement across organisation, technical, and legal dimensions on a timeline
20 mins	3. Summarising Workshop findings and Defining next steps	The facilitator summarises the key findings and participants agree on the follow-up actions.

2.2. Workshop step by step guide

Phase 0: Framing and Icebreaker (recommended allocated time: 15 mins)

The facilitator orients the participants **towards the selected use case** and the overarching project objectives. They list all **relevant project factors** such as: goals, stakeholders, budget. This initial phase ensures that the subsequent discussions remain grounded in a **clear and concrete context**. It also serves to **align all stakeholders** on the purpose, scope,

¹ https://knowledgehub.ldt4ssc.eu/resources_content/methodology/

and expected outcomes of the workshop, fostering a shared understanding before diving into deeper phases.

The facilitator also **organises an icebreaker** designed to foster mental and creative engagement by encouraging participants to adopt a playful, and open mindset. This initial interactive, game-like activity, stimulates imaginative thinking, reduces initial social tension, and prepares participants to engage fully in subsequent workshop phases.

Phase 1: Drafting the Mission Statement (recommended allocated time: 45 mins)

The objective is to **define the key responsibilities and scope** of an ideal Chief Data Officer (CDO). A CDO is a top executive within an organization responsible for defining and implementing data strategy. Participants will consider the scope of the mission and the key functions a CDO should perform. In this workshop, the CDO is fictive and doesn't necessarily exist in the project but their mission statement will guide the action plan creation in the next workshop phase. The participants, by stepping in the shoes of the CDO, can imagine what they would do if they were in charge of the strategy and governance.

To do so, the facilitator divides participants into two subgroups:

1. The first subgroup adopts the perspective of a **local authority director**, focusing on internal data governance needs and developing the mission statement for the data officer role, while seeking a comprehensive understanding of the data and its use within the organization; and
2. the second subgroup represents an **external partner** seeking to develop services using the local authority's data.

Each subgroup can use **the 5W-2H Framework** to identify essential tasks and missions for the data officer (See [Figure 1](#)) and step in the CDO's shoes.

Examples of tasks that may be included in the mission statement

- Raising awareness among business experts about data-related issues.
- Ensuring that data required for use cases is readily accessible.
- Facilitating understanding between business experts and IT management.
- Drafting partnership agreements and terms of use for private data with external organizations.
- Participating in a cross-functional organization within the local authority or consortium to ensure smooth and ethical use of data.
- Utilizing collaborative tools to engage all stakeholders for each use case.

The facilitator guides the discussion, clarifies perspectives (internal authority vs. external partner), and ensures all essential tasks are captured.

In the last 15 minutes, the facilitator brings the groups back together and each presents their findings. Together the groups identify redundancies and complementarities to produce a consolidated mission statement that reflects both internal and external priorities.

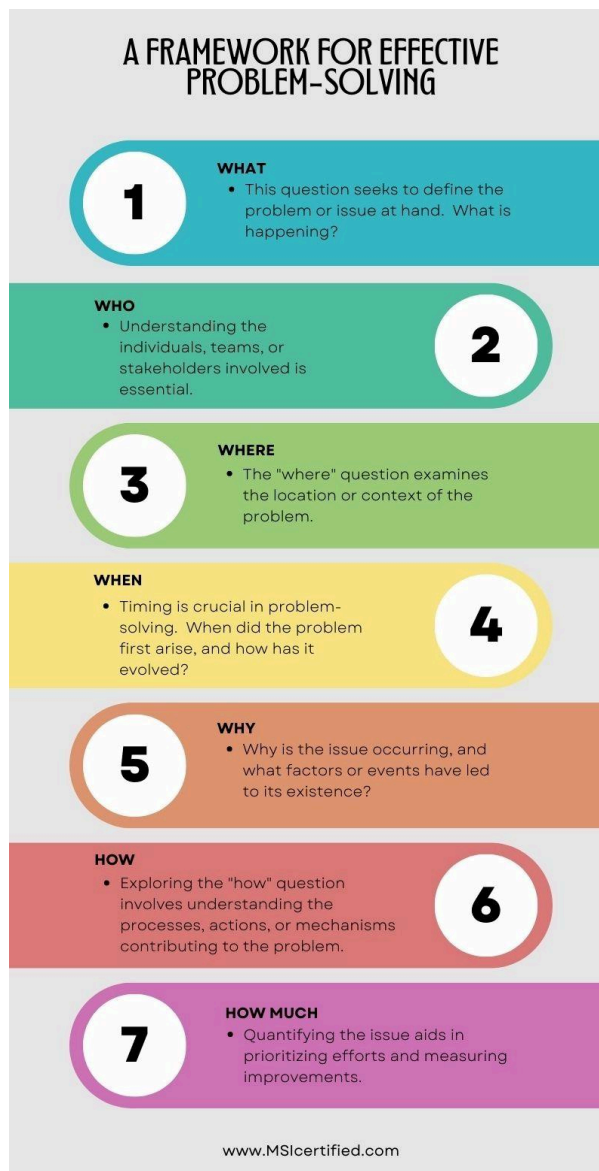


Figure 1: The 5W-2H Framework,
from <https://www.msicertified.com/blog/5w2h-training/>

Phase 2: Build the roadmap (recommended allocated time: 45 mins)

The second session focuses on **translating the mission statement into a structured roadmap** with clear timelines and responsibilities. Participants all work collaboratively on a blank sheet of paper divided into a **time axis** (relevant to the project) and an **implementation axis (Organisational** (including **human resource (HR)**), **Technical, Legal**), using markers and post-it notes to map out actions.

Examples of actions that may be included in the Roadmap

- Selecting individuals to serve as data referents (via internal calls or recruitment).
- Defining processes for managing the entire data lifecycle.
- Establishing a cross-functional "data committee" reporting to the CDO.

- Training all data referents to ensure a shared understanding of data practices.
- Communicating use case achievements through data cross-referencing across business lines and with external partners.

The facilitator can reuse the **preliminary list of required actions and associated timeline** built during the phase 3 of the *2.2.1 Understanding Data Governance and Setting the Goal: From Vision to a First Actionable Roadmap* workshop as a base for discussion.

The facilitator supports the organisation of ideas, ensures clarity in sequencing and interdependencies, and helps the group agree on a sequencing of actions, resulting in a **detailed roadmap** that outlines both sequential and parallel phases for sustainable implementation. The final output serves as a **detailed roadmap** for rolling out the data governance framework effectively.

Phase 3: Summarising Workshop findings and Defining next steps (recommended allocated time: 20 mins)

To conclude the workshop, this phase focuses on **consolidating the key findings** of the workshop and **articulating a clear path forward** for your data governance project.

The facilitator will **summarise the results of the mission statement drafting phase and the roadmap implementation phase**. This summary will serve as a **reference document** for all participants, capturing the **agreed actions** assigned during the workshop.

Finally, the session will close with a **discussion on follow-up actions**, including **scheduled check-ins, progress reviews, and opportunities for further refinement** as the project evolves. The participants can also work on prioritising the actions on the roadmap.

Participants will be invited to **validate the summary** and **confirm their commitment** to the next steps, reinforcing accountability and ownership.

2.3. Recommendations for Workshop facilitation

To ensure the workshop's effectiveness, facilitators are advised to adopt the following approaches:

Encourage Multi-Perspective Analysis

Facilitators should actively **promote multi-perspective thinking** by encouraging participants to consider **viewpoints from both internal authorities and external partners**. This approach ensures that discussions **account for diverse stakeholder interests, operational constraints, and strategic objectives**, fostering a **holistic understanding** of the challenges and opportunities within the data governance framework.

Support Flexibility and Iterative Consensus-Building

Facilitators should **allow groups the flexibility to adjust and reorganise actions** on their visual maps until a **shared consensus** is achieved. This iterative process ensures that the **final output reflects collective agreement** and is **practically feasible**, accommodating the diverse perspectives and realities of all participants.

Emphase on Cross-Functional Alignment

It is essential to **highlight the importance of aligning organisational, technical, and legal functions** throughout the workshop. A **cohesive approach** ensures that governance strategies are **operationally viable, technically sound, and supported by the necessary skills and roles** within the team, thereby enhancing their **effectiveness and sustainability**.

Document Workshop Outputs for Continuity

Facilitators must ensure that **all workshop outputs** are **clearly documented and distributed** to participants. These records serve as a **valuable reference** for **implementing the data governance roadmap** and **guiding subsequent discussions**, ensuring continuity and accountability in the project's progression.

3. Next steps

Once the use case is defined, it is time to specify it in greater depth. To achieve this, one may use workshops from this specification step or move on to workshops from the next step.

The following workshops for the VALIDATE step are:

- *2.2.4 Complementing your Data Governance Roadmap with a Legal Framework: From Mapping Legal Phases to Action*
- *2.2.5 Refining your Legal Framework for Data Governance: Deep dive into legal and contractual requirements*
- *2.3 Inventorying your LDT Project Data: Unlocking Interoperability, Listing and committing to share data among partners*
- *2.4 Identifying Levers, Obstacles and Objectives for Interoperability: From Awareness to Actionable Strategies for LDT Projects*
- *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play: A Transversal Tool to Address and Overcome Data Governance Challenges*

NB: The *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play* workshop is a workshop aimed at unwrapping bottlenecks via the usage of Legos, so it can be paired with any and all workshops in the VALIDATE step.

Next steps:

- *Done: Complete the EXPLORE workshops*
- *Ongoing: Complete the VALIDATE workshops*
- *Complete the DEFINE workshops*
- *Complete the IMPLEMENT workshops*

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